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Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death by Irvin D. Yalom
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"... sooner or later she had to give up the hope for a better past." Like
— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

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"...the more unlived your life, the greater your death anxiety. The more you fail to experience your life fully, the more you will fear death." Like
— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

159 likes

"The pain is there; when you close one door on it, it knocks to come in somewhere else..." Like
— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

91 likes

"Self-awareness is a supreme gift, a treasure as precious as life. This is what makes us human. But it comes with a costly price: the wound of mortality. Our existence is forever shadowed by the knowledge that we will grow, blossom, and, inevitably, diminish and die." Like
— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

tags: awareness, death, life

51 likes

"Why, you may ask, take on this unpleasant, frightening subject? Why stare into the sun? Why not follow the advice of the venerable dean of American psychiatry, Adolph Meyer, who, a century ago, cautioned psychiatrists, 'Don't scratch where it doesn't itch'? Why grapple with the most terrible, the darkest and most unchangeable aspect of life? ... Death, however, DOES itch. It itches all the time; it is always with us, scratching at some inner door, whirring softly, barely audibly, just under the membrane of consciousness." Like
— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

24 likes

"I urge you not to distract yourself. Instead, savor awakening. Take advantage of it. Pause as you stare into the photograph of the younger you. Let the poignant moment sweep over you and linger a bit; taste the sweetness of it as well as the bitterness. Keep in mind the advantage of remaining aware of death, of hugging its shadow to you. Such awareness can integrate the darkness with your spark of life and enhance your life while you still have it. To way to value life, the way to feel compassion Like

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tags: 147

20 likes

“Let me adapt some of Nietzsche's words and say this to you: "To become wise, you must learn to listen to the wild dogs barking in your cellar.”
— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: 211

16 likes

Like

“would you be willing to live this past year again and again for all eternity?”
— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

15 likes

Like

“though the physicality of death destroys us, the idea of death saves us.”
— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Being at Peace with Your Own Mortality

15 likes

Like

“Nu experientele in sine, ci felul in care le interpretam determina calitatea vietii noastre.”
— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

12 likes

Like

“He was saying, fulfill yourself, realize your potential, live boldly and fully. Then, and only then, die without regret.”
— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

8 likes

Like

“I was able to make her own dynamics crystal clear to her by quoting Otto Rank, one of Freud's colleagues, who said, "Some refuse the loan of life to avoid the debt of death." This dynamic is not uncommon. I think most of us have known individuals who numb themselves and avoid entering life with gusto because of the dread of losing too much.”
— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: 109

7 likes

Like

“Obwohl uns die Physikalität des Todes zerstört, rettet uns die Idee des Todes.”
— Irvin D. Yalom, In die Sonne schauen. Wie man die Angst vor dem Tod überwindet

7 likes

Like

“The more unlived your life, the greater your death anxiety.”
— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: carpe-diem, death, death-and-dying, death-anxiety, death-quotes, life-and-death, philosophy, unlived-life

6 likes

Like

“Each of us has a taste of death when slipping into sleep every night or when losing consciousness under anesthesia. Death and sleep, Thanatos and Hypnos in the Greek vocabulary, were twins. The Czech existential novelist Milan Kundera suggests that we also have a foretaste of death

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— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

5 likes

“Each person fears death in his or her own way. For some people, death anxiety is the background music of life, and any activity evokes the thought that a particular moment will never come again. Even an old movie feels poignant to those who cannot stop thinking that all the actors are now only dust.”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: death, dust, fear-of-death

5 likes

Like

“Everyone needs to believe that there are truly wise men and women out there. I sought out such when younger, and now I, elderly and prominent, have become the suitable vessel for others' wishes. I believe that our need for mentors reflects much about our vulnerability and wish for a superior or supreme being.”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: 162

5 likes

Like

“Fiecare alegere presupune o renuntare, si fiecare renuntare ne face constienti de limitare si temporalitate.”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

5 likes

Like

“The way to value life, the way to feel compassion for others, the way to love anything with greatest depth is to be aware that these experiences are destined to be lost.”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

4 likes

Like

“How can you live now without building new regrets? What do you have to change in your life?”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

3 likes

Like

“Properly used, regret is a tool that can help you take actions to prevent its further accumulation.”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: death, life-and-death, life-regrets, regret

3 likes

Like

“Психотерапевты в своей работе всегда исходят из того, что истина, до которой человек дошел сам, намного дороже той, что ему рассказали другие.”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: psyhology

3 likes

Like

“actul uitarii este o forma de moarte cu care ne intalnim mereu in viata.”

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

3 likes

Like

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mirror at your sagging jowls, graying hair, stooping shoulders, the march of birthdays, especially those round decades–fifty, sixty, seventy; meeting a friend you have not seen in a long while and being shocked at how he or she has aged; seeing old photographs of yourself and those long dead who peopled your childhood; encountering Mister Death in a dream.

What do you feel when you have such experiences? What do you do with them? Do you plunge into frenetic activity to burn off the anxiety and avoid the subject? Try to remove wrinkles with cosmetic surgery or dye your hair? Decide to stay thirty-nine for a few more years? Distract yourself quickly with work and everyday life routine? Forget all such experiences? Ignore your dreams?

I urge you not to distract yourself. Instead, savor awakening. Take advantage of it. Pause as you stare

into the photograph of the younger you. Let the poignant moment sweep over you and linger a bit; taste the sweetness of it as well as the bitterness.

Keep in mind the advantage of remaining aware of death, of hugging its shadow to you. Such awareness can integrate the darkness with your spark of life and enhance your life while you still have it. The way to value life, the way to feel compassion for others, the way to love anything with greatest depth is to be aware that these experiences are destined to be lost."

— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

2 likes

"When We Are Tired, We Are Attacked by Ideas We Conquered Long Ago" Like

— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

2 likes

"But despite the staunchest, most venerable defenses, we can never completely subdue death anxiety: it is

always there, lurking in some hidden ravine of the mind. Perhaps, as Plato says, we cannot lie to the deepest part of ourselves.

Had I been a citizen of ancient Athens circa 300 R.C.E. (a time often called the golden age of philosophy) and experienced a death panic or a nightmare, to whom would I have turned to clear my mind of the web of fear? It's likely I'd have trudged off to the agora, a section of ancient Athens where many of the important schools of philosophy were located. I'd have walked past the Academy founded by Plato, now directed by his nephew, Speucippus; and also the Lyceum, the school of Aristotle, once a student of Plato, but too philosophically divergent to be appointed his successor. I'd have passed the schools of the Stoics and the Cynics and ignored any itinerant philosophers searching for students. Finally, I'd have reached the Garden of Epicurus, and there I think I would have found help." Like

— **Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death**

2 likes

"I believe we should confront death as we confront other fears. We should contemplate our ultimate end, familiarize ourselves with it, dissect and analyze it, reason with it, and discard terrifying childhood death distortions. Let's not conclude that death is too painful to bear, that the thought will destroy us, that transiency must be denied lets the Like

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— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

tags: 276

2 likes

“Right, that's exactly what I mean by your being both the prisoner and the jailer.”

Like

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

2 likes

“Sterven is echter de eenzaamste gebeurtenis van het leven. We worden er niet alleen door van anderen afgescheiden, maar daarnaast stelt het ons ook bloot aan een nog angstaanjagender vorm van eenzaamheid: het is een scheiding van de wereld zelf.”

Like

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

2 likes

“we suffer also from our inevitable confrontation with the human condition-the "givens" of existence.
What precisely are these "givens"?
The answer is within each of us and readily available. Set aside some time and meditate on your own existence. Screen out diversions, bracket all preexisting theories and beliefs, and reflect on your "situation" in the world. In time you will inevitably arrive at the deep structures of existence or, to use the theologian Paul Tillich's felicitous term, ultimate concerns. In my view, four ultimate concerns are particularly germane to the practice of therapy: death, isolation, meaning in life, and freedom. These four ultimate concerns constitute the spine of my 1980 textbook, Existential Psychotherapy, in which I discuss, in detail, the phenomenology and the therapeutic implications of each of these concerns.”

Like

— Irvin D. Yalom, Staring at the Sun: Overcoming the Terror of Death

1 likes

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